



Sony's 4k resolution TVs

Sony's upcoming Ultra HDTV series will feature fully compatible support for 4k resolution images and video

LG wins energy efficiency award

LG's LM6700, a mid-range LED backlit LCD TV, won a Super-Efficient Equipment and Appliance Deployment (SEAD) award. More at <http://dgit.in/UDfDt8>

Remembering 2012

The year's most significant events in tech

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The year 2012 has been quite an exciting year for tech. We have seen the launch and coming of age of a few product categories, seen companies fight like children over the look and feel of their respective devices and seen the operating system world turn on its head with desktop and mobile integration.

The number of events that have happened in the world of tech are far too many to list in a few pages, so we have tried here to summarise the events of the year between the good (what made us happy), the bad (stuff that saddened us) and the ugly (stuff that we think went totally wrong)!

The rise of the phablet (Good)

Steve Jobs said that the reason the iPhone had a 3.5-inch screen was because it was easy to navigate with one hand. Then he said that 9.7-inches was right for a tablet was because anything smaller just made no sense.

The consumer market however disagrees. Despite the bulge it will cause in your pocket, the phablet is picking up as a product category that caters to the market that is confused between picking up a smartphone and a tablet.

The Dell Streak, when launched with its five 5-inch display was a precursor of



HTC Droid DNA has failed to make an impression as compared to the Note II

things to come. The implementation was quite shoddy though and consequently the device failed.

Fast-forward to 2011 and Samsung dared to bridge the gap between the smartphone and the tablet with the launch of the Galaxy Note. The device succeeded and the rest, as they say, is history. Asia has seen the biggest demand for the phablet when compared to global sales figure. So its natural, that a country like India has become a hot selling place for these devices. In 2012, we have seen the rise of quite a few smartphone-tablet hybrids that have been christened with the name Phablet. Recently, we saw the launch of the Samsung Galaxy Note II, which has some impressive power under the hood

– a quad-core 1.6 GHz processor, Mali 400MP GPU, a whopping 2 GB of RAM and expandable storage of up to 64 GB, but the price tag of ₹37,000 makes the device quite expensive. There are other products that have tried to take some of the Note's market share like the LG Optimus VU and the HTC Droid DNA but sadly, these products have failed to make an impression.

Since the category is relatively new, we have seen the rise of quite a few local companies entering the fray with budget phablets such as the iBall Andi 5c, Micromax Superfone Canvas A100 and the I10 and the WickedLeak Wammy Note.

The consumer is spoiled for choice. And the fact that more and more manufacturers want a bite of the phablet pie indicates that the category has just started heating up.

Talk to me (Bad)

Five years ago, if someone told you that you'd be able to talk "to" your phone and it would talk back to you, you'd probably not believe it. Now you have several talking phones each with its own electronic avatar – Siri, Aisha, S-Voice – you can take your pick.

Just like many other things, Apple started the trend of talking to your smartphone by launching Siri with the iPhone 4S and a slew of third party apps have followed suit on the Android platform. We have even seen our very own *desi* assistant in the form of Aisha as a voice controlled personal assistant on Micromax budget Android smartphones.

Unfortunately, none of these assistants are perfect and have a long way to go before they reach the capabilities of the "Heart of Gold" (Read *Hitchbiker's guide to*